SSC CHSL 2019 Tier-I question paper with answers

14 October 2020 · Shift 2

49 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 51 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20210126081103/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerkeyCHSL2019T1_22012021.pdf

English Language (Basic Knowledge) 24 questions

Q.1

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options pick the one that gives their correct order. A. It is also very sad that ill-treatment is meted out to one of your gifts, and everyone indulges in excess!" B. "I can't take it anymore," he complained. "People abuse me and exploit me, and there is no respect for me – no realisation that I am your prasadam to men! C. An ancient story tells us that the God of Food came before the Divine Presence, battered, exhausted, and downcast. D. The Lord smiled and said to him, "Those who abuse you and indulge in excess are destroying themselves."

(A) ACDB
(B) BADC
(C) CBAD
(D) CABD

Q.2

Select the correct passive form of the given sentence. I use baking soda to remove stains from my clothes.

(A) Baking soda is being used by me to remove stains from my clothes.
(B) Baking soda is used by me to remove stains from my clothes.
(C) I have been using baking soda to remove stains from my clothes.
(D) Baking soda was used by me to remove stains from my clothes.

Q.3

Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence. Aanya said, "I've made a rose and honey vanilla dessert for you."

(A) Aanya told me that she had made a rose and honey vanilla dessert for me.
(B) Aanya told me that she is making a rose and honey vanilla dessert for me.
(C) Aanya told me that she would make a rose and honey vanilla dessert for her.
(D) Aanya said to me that she was making a rose and honey vanilla dessert for me.

Q.4

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Marriage
(B) Symphony
(C) Intriging
(D) Separate

Q.5

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. One fireman died while 14 others had a narrow escape when a part of the factory-cum-outlet of a well-known battery (1)_____ firm where they were battling a major (2)_____ collapsed following a series of sudden explosions in west Delhi. The brave fireman who had joined the department last year and got married (3)_____, was buried under a pile of debris following explosions which were (4)_____ by a compressor burst. The fireman died due to (5)_____ bleeding and smoke inhalation. It took firemen five hours to pull his body out of the debris.

Select the most appropriate option for blank number 1.

(A) manufactures
(B) manufacturable
(C) manufactured
(D) manufacturing

Q.6

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. One fireman died while 14 others had a narrow escape when a part of the factory-cum-outlet of a well-known battery (1)_____ firm where they were battling a major (2)_____ collapsed following a series of sudden explosions in west Delhi. The brave fireman who had joined the department last year and got married (3)_____, was buried under a pile of debris following explosions which were (4)_____ by a compressor burst. The fireman died due to (5)_____ bleeding and smoke inhalation. It took firemen five hours to pull his body out of the debris.

Select the most appropriate option for blank number 2.

(A) trouble
(B) blaze
(C) fracture
(D) ruin

Q.7

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. One fireman died while 14 others had a narrow escape when a part of the factory-cum-outlet of a well-known battery (1)_____ firm where they were battling a major (2)_____ collapsed following a series of sudden explosions in west Delhi. The brave fireman who had joined the department last year and got married (3)_____, was buried under a pile of debris following explosions which were (4)_____ by a compressor burst. The fireman died due to (5)_____ bleeding and smoke inhalation. It took firemen five hours to pull his body out of the debris.

Select the most appropriate option for blank number 3.

(A) evidently
(B) recently
(C) generously
(D) eventually

Q.8

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. One fireman died while 14 others had a narrow escape when a part of the factory-cum-outlet of a well-known battery (1)_____ firm where they were battling a major (2)_____ collapsed following a series of sudden explosions in west Delhi. The brave fireman who had joined the department last year and got married (3)_____, was buried under a pile of debris following explosions which were (4)_____ by a compressor burst. The fireman died due to (5)_____ bleeding and smoke inhalation. It took firemen five hours to pull his body out of the debris.

Select the most appropriate option for blank number 4.

(A) advocated
(B) horrified
(C) amazed
(D) triggered

Q.9

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. One fireman died while 14 others had a narrow escape when a part of the factory-cum-outlet of a well-known battery (1)_____ firm where they were battling a major (2)_____ collapsed following a series of sudden explosions in west Delhi. The brave fireman who had joined the department last year and got married (3)_____, was buried under a pile of debris following explosions which were (4)_____ by a compressor burst. The fireman died due to (5)_____ bleeding and smoke inhalation. It took firemen five hours to pull his body out of the debris.

Select the most appropriate option for blank number 5.

(A) exorbitant
(B) towering
(C) lavish
(D) excessive

Q.10

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. I found the scene of some people making fun of a beggar quite _____.

(A) destructive
(B) sociable
(C) repulsive
(D) admirable

Q.11

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. PROVOKE

(A) Beckon
(B) Encourage
(C) Appease
(D) Stimulate

Q.12

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. PREJUDICE

(A) Advantage
(B) Tolerance
(C) Justice
(D) Bias

Q.13

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains the grammatical error. A panel has been formed to look within the security needs of college students.

(A) the security needs
(B) of college students
(C) to look within
(D) has been formed

Q.14

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Pick the option that gives their correct order. A. When we wish to achieve something, we cannot expect success in a moment. B. It is the same with any great achievement. C. It took several years to build Rome and bring it to the state of glory. D. Rome, the greatest city of ancient world was not built in a short time.

(A) CDAB
(B) BACD
(C) ABCD
(D) DCBA

Q.15

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No improvement'. She is quite capable of looking after herself, "aren't she"?

(A) isn't she
(B) No improvement
(C) won't she
(D) wasn't she

Q.16

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Add insult to injury

(A) Make a bad situation even worse
(B) Play a prank on someone
(C) Say words that are very offensive
(D) Hurt someone physically

Q.17

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. PERSECUTION

(A) Perfection
(B) Affliction
(C) Oppression
(D) Stimulation

Q.18

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Jump on the bandwagon

(A) Get involved in an activity because it is likely to succeed
(B) Do an activity that is fun
(C) Do something because circumstances force you to
(D) Get engaged in an activity that is very important

Q.19

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No improvement'. Doctors at the AIIMS Trauma Centre managed to save the life of 12 year old archer Shivangini, "whose were struck" by an arrow in the neck during a practice session.

(A) who was striked
(B) which was struck
(C) No improvement
(D) who was struck

Q.20

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. The scientist, who is known for his _____ ideas on space travel, is much admired.

(A) ridiculous
(B) anarchist
(C) revolutionary
(D) malicious

Q.21

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. DISAPPROVE

(A) Commend
(B) Refuse
(C) Oppose
(D) Neglect

Q.22

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. One who tells future from the stars

(A) Miser
(B) Personification
(C) Philanthropist
(D) Astrologer

Q.24

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. Movement of people or animals from one area to another

(A) Diversification
(B) Migration
(C) Acclimatisation
(D) Population

Q.25

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains the grammatical error. The performance of our players is worst than I had expected.

(A) I had
(B) worst than
(C) The performance
(D) our players

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

Where is Bishnupur, which is famous for terracotta temples, located?

(A) Rajasthan
(B) Gujarat
(C) West Bengal
(D) Assam

Q.2

How many members of the Rajya Sabha can be nominated by the President of India?

(A) 14 members
(B) 10 members
(C) 16 members
(D) 12 members

Q.3

Which of the following units is used for the measurement of Luminous Intensity?

(A) Mole
(B) Ampere
(C) Kelvin
(D) Candela

Q.4

In January 2020, the Yashaswini Scheme for Women Entrepreneurship was launched in Goa. The scheme aims to support female Self Help Groups (SHGs) with interest-free loans up to:

(A) ₹50 lakh
(B) ₹10 lakh
(C) ₹1 lakh
(D) ₹5 lakh

Q.5

Which of the following elements occurs most abundantly in our universe?

(A) Nitrogen
(B) Oxygen
(C) Hydrogen
(D) Silicon

Q.6

Who among the following is credited with the discovery of neutrons?

(A) J Chadwick
(B) James P Joule
(C) E Rutherford
(D) JJ Thomson

Q.7

Which of the following is a Rabi crop?

(A) Bajra
(B) Jowar
(C) Tur
(D) Wheat

Q.8

In context of computing, what is the full form of URL?

(A) Undistributed Resource Locator
(B) Unified Resource Locator
(C) Uniform Resource Locator
(D) Uniform Region Locator

Q.9

Which of the following freedom fighters was NOT involved in the Kakori Train Robbery?

(A) Bhagat Singh
(B) Ashfaqullah Khan
(C) Ram Prasad Bismil
(D) Chandrashekhar Azad

Q.10

The Thar Desert, also known as the Great Indian Desert, lies towards the western margins of _____ hills.

(A) Udgalakal
(B) Aravali
(C) Shevroy
(D) Javadi

Q.11
As of 15 January 2020, which of the following nations is the number one ranked team in the 'ICC Men's T20I Team Rankings'?

(A) Australia
(B) India
(C) England
(D) Pakistan

Q.12
Which of the following words was inserted in the Preamble by the Constitution (42nd Amendment) Act, 1976?

(A) Equality
(B) Liberty
(C) Justice
(D) Socialist

Q.13
Which of the following is used to receive and send computer files over telephone lines?

(A) Modem
(B) MICR device
(C) Floppy disk
(D) Light pen

Q.14
Who among the following is responsible for preparation of National Income estimates in India?

(A) Central Statistical Organization
(B) IRDA
(C) Finance Commission
(D) NITI Aayog

Q.15
Which of the following is a well known place for Chikankari embroidery?

(A) Ranchi
(B) Lucknow
(C) Raipur
(D) Indore

Q.16
As of 15 January 2020, who among the following was the number one ranked male tennis player in the ATP rankings?

(A) Novak Djokovic
(B) Roger Federer
(C) Rafael Nadal
(D) Daniil Medvedev

Q.17
Which of the following articles of the Constitution of India was invoked by the Kerala government to file a petition against the Citizenship (Amendment) Act (CAA) in the Supreme Court on 14 January 2020?

(A) Article 131
(B) Article 23
(C) Article 368
(D) Article 17

Q.18
Who among the following wrote 'Akbar Nama'?

(A) Amir Khushro
(B) Akbar
(C) Abul Fazl
(D) Birbal

Q.19
Which of the following passes cuts through Pir Panjal range and links Manali and Leh by road?

(A) Rohtang Pass
(B) Banihal Pass
(C) Nathula Pass
(D) Baralachala Pass

Q.20

Who among the following was the first non-Indian to receive the Bharat Ratna, the highest Indian honour that can be given to civilians?

(A) Josip Broz Tito
(B) Nelson Mandela
(C) Mikhail Gorbachev
(D) Abdul Ghaffar Khan

Q.21

Who among the following won the 'Golden Globe 2020 award' for 'Best Performance by an Actress in a Motion Picture – Drama'?

(A) Charlize Theron
(B) Renée Zellweger
(C) Cynthia Erivo
(D) Beanie Feldstein

Q.22

Which of the following teams won the 2018-19 Santosh Trophy?

(A) Mizoram
(B) Railways
(C) Punjab
(D) Services

Q.23

Which of the following is a tertiary economic activity?

(A) Farming
(B) Trading
(C) Hunting
(D) Weaving

Q.24

Who among the following won ICC's 'Spirit of Cricket Award' for the year 2019?

(A) Chris Gayle
(B) Faf du Plessis
(C) Mahendra Singh Dhoni
(D) Virat Kohli

Q.25

How many Indian biosphere reserves are included in the UNESCO World Network of Biosphere Reserves, as of October 2019?

(A) 9
(B) 14
(C) 11
(D) 17

Answer key

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(B)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Explanations

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 · Answer (C) CBAD

C opens the story with the God of Food coming before the Divine Presence, B begins his complaint, A continues it, and D gives the Lord's reply: CBAD.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Baking soda is used by me to remove stains from my clothes.

The simple present 'use' becomes 'is used' with the singular subject 'baking soda': 'Baking soda is used by me to remove stains from my clothes.'

Q.3 · Answer (A) Aanya told me that she had made a rose and honey vanilla dessert for me.

In reported speech the present perfect 'I've made' becomes the past perfect 'she had made', and 'you' becomes 'me', the listener.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Intriging

The correct spelling is 'intriguing', with a 'u' after the 'g'.

Q.5 · Answer (D) manufacturing

A 'battery manufacturing firm' is a firm that makes batteries; 'manufacturing' describes the kind of firm.

Q.6 · Answer (B) blaze

The firemen were battling a major 'blaze', a large and fierce fire.

Q.7 · Answer (B) recently

He had joined the department only last year and got married 'recently', a short time ago.

Q.8 · Answer (D) triggered

The explosions were 'triggered', that is set off, by a compressor burst.

Q.9 · Answer (D) excessive

'Excessive' bleeding is bleeding beyond the normal amount. 'Exorbitant' is used of prices, and 'towering' and 'lavish' do not describe bleeding.

Q.10 · Answer (C) repulsive

People mocking a beggar is a sight that causes disgust: 'repulsive'. 'Admirable' and 'sociable' go against the sense, and 'destructive' does not fit.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Appease

To 'provoke' is to stir up anger; to 'appease' is to calm or pacify. 'Encourage' and 'stimulate' are close to 'provoke', and 'beckon' means to signal someone to come.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Bias

'Prejudice' is an unfair opinion formed in advance: 'bias'. 'Tolerance' and 'justice' are nearly opposite.

Q.13 · Answer (C) to look within

To examine or investigate something is to 'look into' it, not 'look within': 'to look into the security needs of college students'.

Q.14 · Answer (D) DCBA

D gives the saying that Rome was not built in a short time, C explains that it took several years, B extends this to any great achievement, and A applies it to us: DCBA.

Q.15 · Answer (A) isn't she

A positive statement with 'is' takes the negative tag 'isn't' with the same subject pronoun: 'She is quite capable of looking after herself, isn't she?'

Q.16 · Answer (A) Make a bad situation even worse

To 'add insult to injury' is to make a bad situation even worse for someone.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Oppression
'Persecution' is cruel and unjust treatment of people, often for their beliefs or origin: 'oppression'. 'Affliction' is suffering in general, not ill-treatment by others.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Get involved in an activity because it is likely to succeed
To 'jump on the bandwagon' is to join an activity or cause because it is popular or looks likely to succeed.

Q.19 · Answer (D) who was struck
'Who' refers to the person, Shivangini, and the singular past passive is 'was struck': 'struck' is the past participle of 'strike', and 'striked' is not a word.

Q.20 · Answer (C) revolutionary
A scientist much admired for his ideas on space travel would have 'revolutionary' ones, that is new and far-reaching. 'Ridiculous' and 'malicious' ideas would not win admiration, and 'anarchist' does not describe them.

Q.21 · Answer (A) Commend
To 'disapprove' is to have an unfavourable opinion; to 'commend' is to praise. 'Refuse' and 'oppose' are close in sense to 'disapprove'.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Astrologer
An astrologer claims to tell the future from the positions of the stars and planets. A philanthropist gives money to help others, and a miser hoards it.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Migration
Migration is the movement of people or animals from one area to another. Acclimatisation is getting used to a new climate or place.

Q.25 · Answer (B) worst than
A comparison with 'than' needs the comparative 'worse', not the superlative 'worst': 'is worse than I had expected'.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) West Bengal
Bishnupur, in Bankura district of West Bengal, is known for the terracotta temples built by the Malla kings in the 17th and 18th centuries.

Q.2 · Answer (D) 12 members
Under Article 80 the President nominates 12 members of the Rajya Sabha with special knowledge or practical experience of literature, science, art and social service.

Q.3 · Answer (D) Candela
The candela is the SI unit of luminous intensity. The mole measures the amount of substance, the ampere electric current and the kelvin temperature.

Q.4 · Answer (D) ₹5 lakh
The Yashaswini scheme, launched near Panaji on 11 January 2020, offers women's self-help groups in Goa interest-free loans of up to ₹5 lakh.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Hydrogen
Hydrogen is the most abundant element in the universe, making up about three-quarters of its ordinary matter by mass.

Q.6 · Answer (A) J Chadwick
James Chadwick discovered the neutron in 1932 and received the Nobel Prize in Physics for it in 1935. J J Thomson discovered the electron, and Rutherford the atomic nucleus.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Wheat
SSC's key gives wheat, the one option grown only as a rabi crop: it is sown in winter, from October to December, and harvested from April to June. Bajra and tur (arhar) are kharif crops, sown with the monsoon; NCERT also lists jowar among the kharif crops, though in the southern states it is sown in the rabi season too.

Q.8 · Answer (C) Uniform Resource Locator
URL stands for Uniform Resource Locator, the address of a resource on the internet, such as a web page.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Bhagat Singh
The Kakori train robbery of 9 August 1925 was carried out by revolutionaries of the Hindustan Republican Association, among them Ram Prasad Bismil, Ashfaqulla Khan and Chandrashekhar Azad. Bhagat Singh was not part of it.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Aravali
NCERT describes the Indian (Thar) Desert as lying towards the western margins of the Aravali hills.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Pakistan
Pakistan was ranked first in the ICC Men's T20I Team Rankings in January 2020; Australia overtook it in the ICC's annual update of May 2020.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Socialist
The 42nd Amendment (1976) added 'Socialist', 'Secular' and 'Integrity' to the Preamble. 'Justice', 'Liberty' and 'Equality' were there from the start.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Modem
A modem (modulator-demodulator) turns a computer's digital signals into analogue ones that a telephone line can carry, and back again.

Q.14 · Answer (A) Central Statistical Organization
SSC's key gives the Central Statistical Organisation (CSO), which prepared India's national income estimates. In May 2019, before the exam was held (October 2020), it was merged with the NSSO into the National Statistical Office (NSO), which took over this work.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Lucknow
Chikankari, fine embroidery traditionally done in white thread on light cotton or muslin, is the best-known craft of Lucknow.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Rafael Nadal
Rafael Nadal was ranked number one in the ATP rankings in January 2020; Novak Djokovic took the top place back in February 2020, after winning the Australian Open.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Article 131
Kerala filed an original suit against the CAA under Article 131, which gives the Supreme Court original jurisdiction in disputes between the Centre and the states. It was the first state to challenge the Act in the Supreme Court.

Q.18 · Answer (C) Abul Fazl
The 'Akbarnama', the official history of Akbar's reign, was written by his courtier Abul Fazl; its third volume is the 'Ain-i-Akbari'.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Rohtang Pass
The Rohtang Pass, on the Pir Panjal range, carries the Manali-Leh road from the Kullu valley into Lahaul. The Banihal Pass, also in the Pir Panjal, links Jammu with Srinagar instead.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Abdul Ghaffar Khan
Khan Abdul Ghaffar Khan, the 'Frontier Gandhi', received the Bharat Ratna in 1987, the first person who was not an Indian citizen to do so; Nelson Mandela received it in 1990.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Renée Zellweger
Renée Zellweger won the 2020 Golden Globe for Best Performance by an Actress in a Motion Picture – Drama for playing Judy Garland in 'Judy'.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Services
Services won the 2018-19 Santosh Trophy, beating the hosts Punjab 1-0 in the final at Ludhiana in April 2019.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Trading
Tertiary activities provide services rather than goods, and trade is one of them. Farming and hunting are primary activities, and weaving, which makes a product, is secondary.

Q.24 · Answer (D) Virat Kohli
Virat Kohli won the ICC Spirit of Cricket Award for 2019, announced in January 2020, for asking Indian fans at the World Cup to stop booing Steve Smith and applaud him instead.

Q.25 · Answer (C) 11
As of October 2019, 11 of India's 18 biosphere reserves were in UNESCO's World Network, the latest being Khangchendzonga, added in 2018. Panna joined in 2020.

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